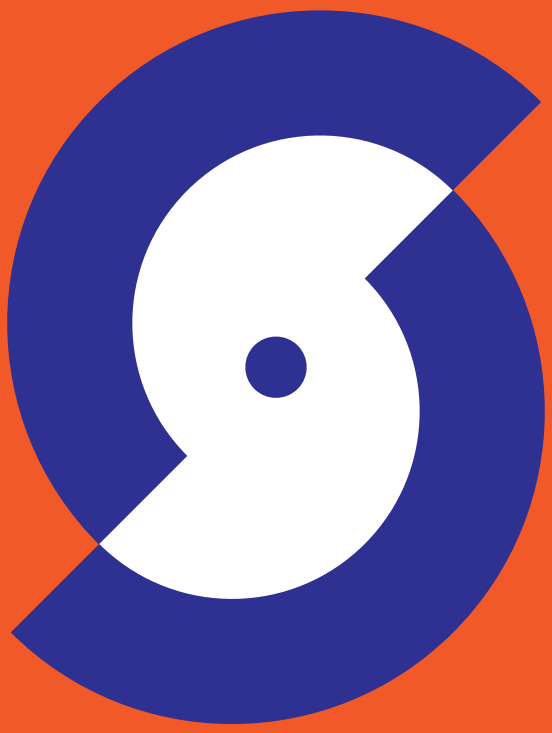
BUILDING THE BRAND IDENTITY OF THE STUDIO AT COLBY

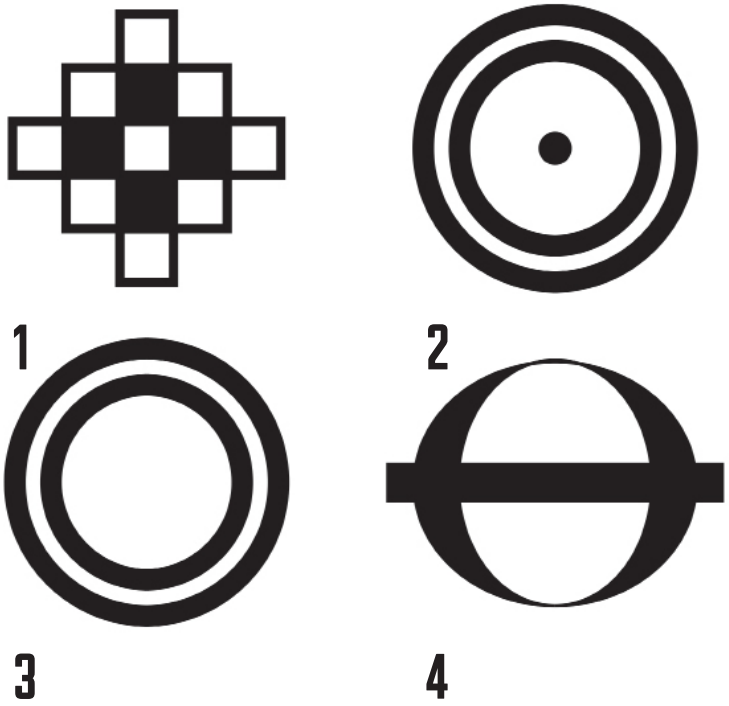


ALEX DUAN

INITIAL DIRECTION

The Studio at Colby is a student-led recording facility based at Colby College. This brand identity was created to balance the vibrant creative energy of the student body with the technical precision and reliable expertise of a professional studio. To establish the visual direction, I began by gathering key symbols that symbolized the work that is being done at the Studio.

SYMBOLS

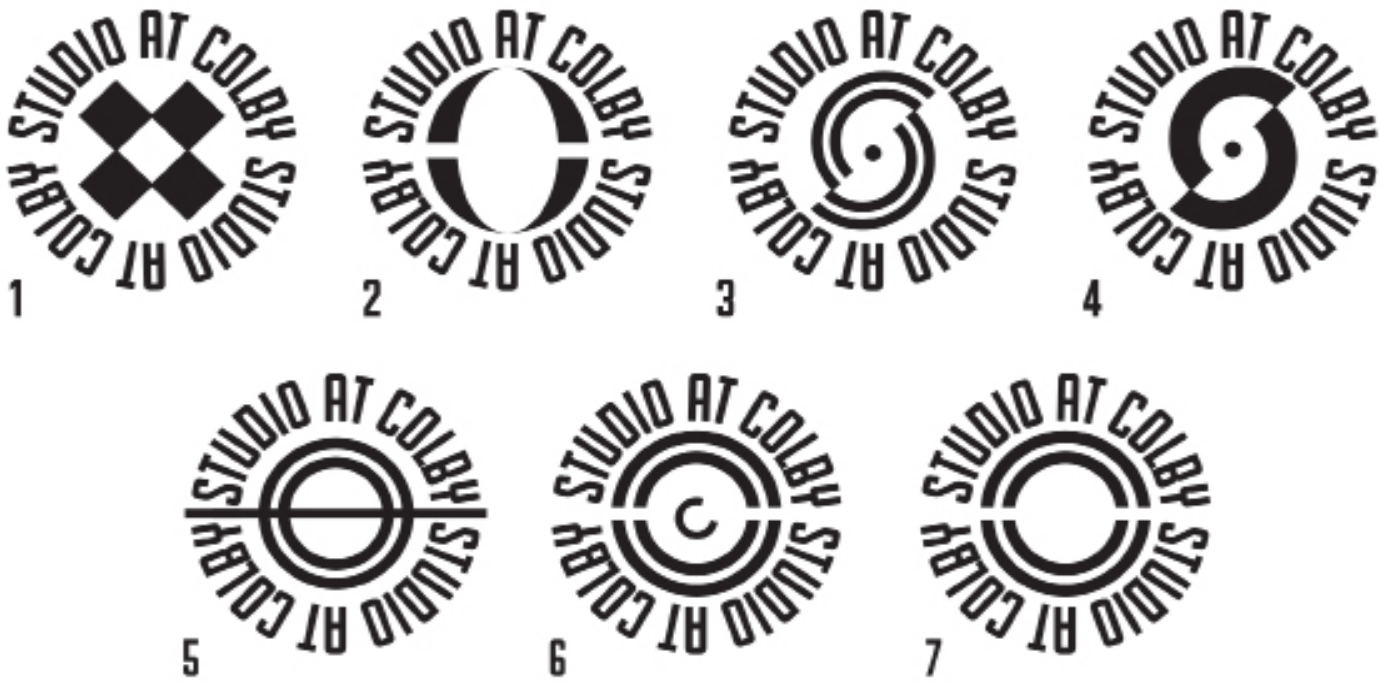


(1) The acoustic shelfing in the studio; (2) A vector repersentation of a vinyl; (3) A record UI typically seen within apps; (4) The middle C repersenting C for Colby College

To uncover meaningful visual cues, I spent time inside the physical studio observing its architecture, equipment, and environment. The geometric grid of the acoustic diffusers on the back wall immediately caught my eye. I also drew inspiration from vinyl records, hoping to bridge between classic audio heritage and modern production.

Turning to the digital side of production, I extracted elements from Digital Audio Workstation (DAW) interfaces like Logic Pro, specifically referencing the universal record button UI. Finally, to anchor the identity in Colby College, I incorporated the musical note Middle C. It repersents a double-meaning symbol that references both fundamental music theory and the ‘C’ in Colby.

INITIAL LOGOS



Initial logo designs pulling on the symbols mentioned before

These were the initial logo concepts. Concept 1 draws from the studio's acoustic shelving. Concept 2 builds upon the Middle C note using an implied line. Concepts 3 and 4 are very similar, both incorporating imagery of a vinyl record and a record button. The negative space in the middle of the design also spell out an S symbolzing the studio. Concepts 5 and 7 are closely related: Concept 5 uses a solid line to represent the C and the record button, whereas the line in Concept 7 is implied. Concept 6 expands on that implied line by integrating a C that doubles as an audio control knob. The final voted on logo was close between 3 and 4, so I decided to move on with both designs due to the similarity already existing between the two.

TYPEFACE

STUDIO AT COLBY

I selected the sans-serif typeface Komu New C for its bold weight and clean, straight edges. This clean geometry provides great versatility while creating a balanced contrast against the softer, circular elements of the mark.

LOGO CONCEPT

The final mark features a deconstructed vinyl record split to reveal a bold negative space “S” for Studio. This slicing directly reflects the audio production process: deconstructing raw recordings, cutting stems, and reconstructing them into a finished track. At the center, the spindle hole doubles as a subtle reference to a DAW record button, while the curved typography wraps around the icon to mirror the circular format of a physical record label.

The color palette establishes a balance between authority and creative passion. Deep navy blue **(#2e388e)** anchors the logo to Colby College’s institutional colors while signaling technical reliability, expertise, and trust. In contrast, the vibrant orange **(#ef4136)** injects warmth, enthusiasm, and the youthful energy of the student-led team. Together, these elements capture the duality of The Studio at Colby as a high-precision audio facility driven by artistic expression.

Reflecting on this project, the final brand system successfully translates the dynamic environment of a recording studio into a cohesive visual identity. Taking complex audio concepts into essential geometric shapes allowed me to create a flexible mark that scales seamlessly across physical studio signage, equipment decals, apparel, and digital media. Designing for a student-run space highlighted the importance of striking a balance between approachability for young artists and the technical authority expected in sound engineering. The identity gives The Studio at Colby a distinct voice that honors both its artistic spirit and professional standards.







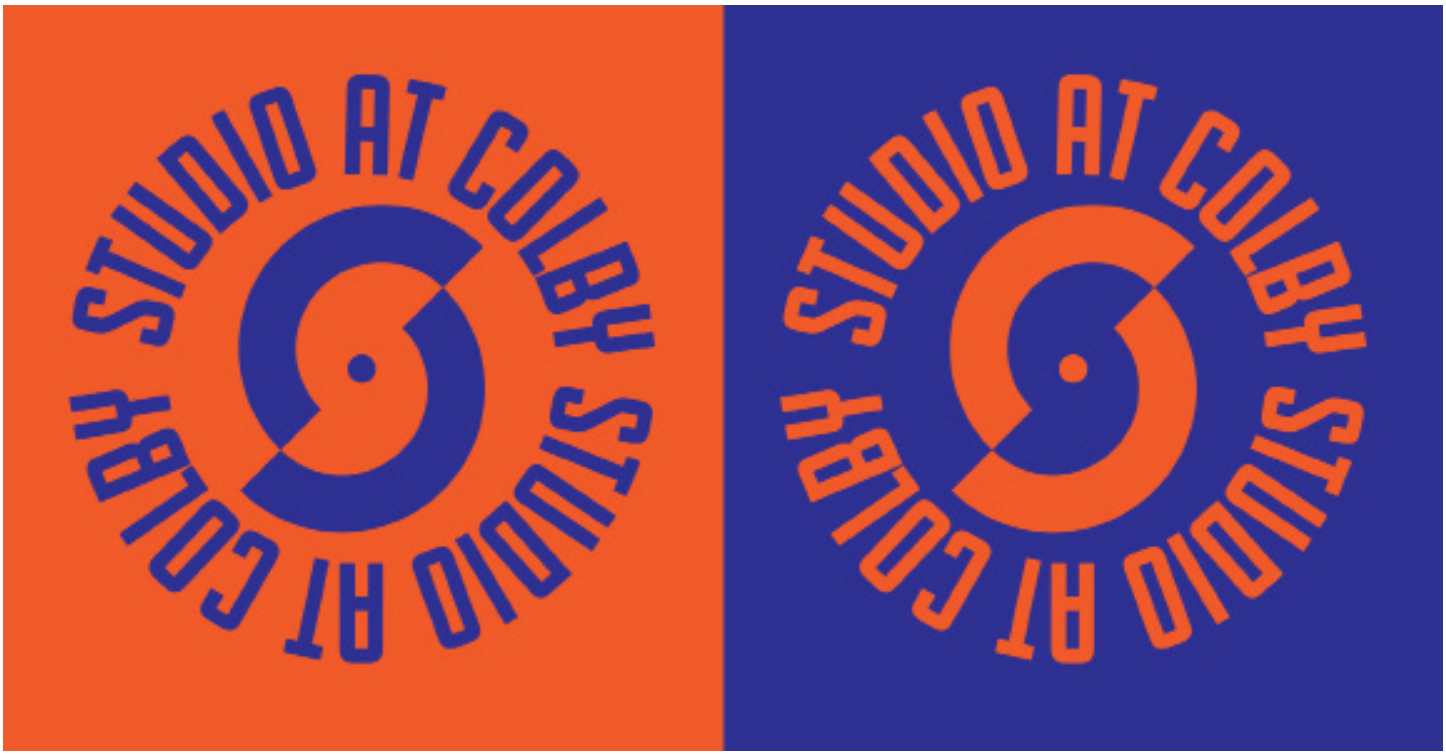
FINAL LOGO

PRIMARY LOGOS





MONOCHROME LOGOS



SECONDARY LOGOS

STUDIO AT COLBY







PATTERN MARK + MOCKUP

